MODERN INDIA I · DAY 4 OF 6 · TEST ON 31 OCT 2026

Company Administration under British Rule

Civil services, army, judiciary, land revenue, education, press, economy

HOW TO USE THIS NOTE

1. Read the overview table first (5 min).
2. Then read section by section. Each ends with the exam traps and links.
3. Finish with the traps and memory hooks, then start the 50 questions.

The big picture

Today's test (T3-04, Modern India I, Day 4 of 6) asks how the Company actually ruled India after 1765: who ran it (civil service, army, police, courts), how it took money from the land, what it taught, what it let people print, and what it did to the economy. Every one of the 50 questions falls into one of the eight boxes below.

The logic in one line: the Company needed (1) money, so it fixed land revenue; (2) loyal staff, so it built a civil service; (3) order, so it built an army, police and courts; (4) a class of English-educated clerks and allies, so it set up education; (5) silence from critics, so it controlled the press. The result was (6) a colonial economy, with famines and a drain of wealth.

Pillar	Built mainly by	Key year	One-line hook
Civil service	Cornwallis	1786–93	"Father of the civil service"; high pay, no private trade, no Indians at the top
Army	Company, reorganised after 1857	Peel Commission appointed 1858, reported 1859	Sepoys led by British officers; three Presidency armies

Pillar	Built mainly by	Key year	One-line hook
Police	Cornwallis	1793	Took police away from zamindars; thanas under darogas
Judiciary	Hastings, then Cornwallis	1772, 1793	Hastings built the courts; Cornwallis separated revenue and justice
Land revenue	Cornwallis, Read and Munro, Holt Mackenzie	1793, 1820, 1822/1833	Zamindar, ryot, village (mahal)
Education	Hastings, Macaulay, Wood	1781, 1835, 1854	Oriental colleges, then English education, then a full system
Press	Wellesley, Adam, Metcalfe, Lytton	1799, 1823, 1835, 1878	Censor, license, liberate, gag
Economy	Charter Acts, Dalhousie	1813, 1833, 1853	Free trade ruins crafts; railways serve trade; famine and drain

Master timeline (memorise the order, not just the dates)

Year	Event	Under
1765	Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa to the Company	Clive
1770	Great Bengal famine	Cartier
1772	Hastings' judicial plan; five-year revenue farming	Warren Hastings
1773	Regulating Act; Supreme Court at Calcutta (court opened 1774)	Warren Hastings
1775	Nandakumar hanged for forgery	Warren Hastings
1780	Hicky's Bengal Gazette, first newspaper	Warren Hastings

Year	Event	Under
1781	Calcutta Madrasa	Warren Hastings
1791	Sanskrit College, Benares (Jonathan Duncan)	Cornwallis
1793	Cornwallis Code; Permanent Settlement; police reform	Cornwallis
1799	Censorship of Press Act	Wellesley
1800	Fort William College	Wellesley
1806	East India College, Haileybury (England)	Barlow
1813	Charter Act: ₹1 lakh for education; trade monopoly ends except tea and China	Minto I / Hastings (Moira)
1820	Ryotwari formalised in Madras (Munro as Governor)	Hastings (Moira)
1822	Mahalwari begins (Holt Mackenzie, Regulation VII)	Hastings (Moira)
1823	Licensing Regulations; General Committee of Public Instruction	John Adam
1829	Sati abolished (Regulation XVII)	Bentinck
1833	Charter Act: no bar on Indians, Law Commission, Company stops trading; Regulation IX (Mahalwari)	Bentinck
1835	Macaulay's Minute (Feb) and Bentinck's Resolution (7 March); Metcalfe's Press Act	Bentinck / Metcalfe
1853	Charter Act: open competition; first train, Bombay–Thane	Dalhousie
1854	Wood's Despatch; Post Office Act; PWD; Macaulay Committee	Dalhousie
1857	Universities at Calcutta, Bombay, Madras; Licensing Act	Canning
1859	Bengal Rent Act (Act X)	Canning
1860–62	IPC (1860), Police Act and High Courts Act (1861), High Courts open (1862)	Canning / Elgin I

The Charter Acts and the Regulating Act were covered on Day 2; here they appear only where they changed administration.

1. Civil services

Cornwallis (1786–93) is the **Father of the Civil Service in India**: he turned the Company's corrupt trading clerks into a paid, rule-bound administrative service, but kept Indians out of its higher posts. Everything after him is a slow fight over two questions: how to recruit (patronage or exam) and whether Indians get in.

Stage 1: Company servants become administrators (1765–1806)

- Before Cornwallis, Company servants were paid little and earned through private trade, gifts and bribes. Clive and Hastings tried to stop this, with little success.
- **Cornwallis's reforms:** high salaries; private trade and gifts banned; promotion by seniority, so officers were not dependent on favour.
- The **Charter Act of 1793** reserved all posts worth £500 a year or more for the Company's covenanted servants. In practice this shut Indians out.
- Result: a service relatively free of the old corruption, but racially closed. The Company did not trust Indians, and higher posts were kept as rewards for British families.
- **Wellesley** founded **Fort William College, Calcutta (1800)** to train young civilians in Indian languages, law and history. UPSC 2020 asked why he founded it: to train British civilians for administration.
- The Directors disliked it and set up the **East India College at Haileybury, England (1806)**, a two-year course. Fort William College continued only as a language school.
- Recruitment was still by **nomination by the Directors** (patronage).

Stage 2: Open door on paper, open exam in law (1833–1861)

- **Charter Act 1833 (Section 87):** no Indian could be barred from any office because of religion, place of birth, descent or colour. In

practice, no Indian was appointed. (Bentinck did open uncovenanted posts such as deputy collector and sadar amin to Indians.)

- **Charter Act 1853:** ended patronage; the covenanted civil service was to be filled by **open competition**, Indians included.
- **Macaulay Committee (1854):** laid down the plan for the exam (Committee on the Indian Civil Service); a Civil Service Commission was set up in London in 1855.
- **First exam, 1855, held only in London.** Upper age limit 23. Haileybury closed in 1858.
- **Indian Civil Services Act, 1861:** reserved key posts for covenanted (ICS) officers recruited by the open exam.

Stage 3: Indians enter, Britain moves the goalposts (1863–1892)

- **Satyendranath Tagore** (Rabindranath's brother) became the **first Indian to qualify for the ICS, in 1863**.
- The upper age limit was cut from 23 to 22 (1860), 21 (1866) and **19 (1876)**, making it very hard for Indians, who had to sail to London. Surendranath Banerjee's Indian Association ran an all-India campaign against this (1877–78).
- **Statutory Civil Service (1878–79, Lytton):** up to one-sixth of covenanted posts filled by **nomination** of Indians "of good family". It was disliked and abolished on the Aitchison Commission's advice.
- **Aitchison Commission (1886, Dufferin):** dropped the covenanted / uncovenanted division; created three tiers — **Imperial (ICS), Provincial and Subordinate** services; age limit raised to 23; Statutory Civil Service to end.

Stage 4: Indianisation (1912–1947)

- **Islington Commission (Royal Commission on Public Services, 1912–15):** about 25% of higher posts for Indians, partly by recruitment in India.
- **Montagu–Chelmsford Report (1918) / Government of India Act 1919:** exams held simultaneously in India and England from **1922**

(first at Allahabad); a share of posts for Indians rising each year; provided for a Public Service Commission.

- **Lee Commission (1923–24):** Secretary of State to keep recruiting ICS, IP and a few services; **50:50 British–Indian parity** within about 15 years; immediate setting up of a Public Service Commission. The **Public Service Commission was set up in 1926** (chaired by Sir Ross Barker).
- **Government of India Act 1935:** a Federal Public Service Commission and provincial commissions, the parents of today's UPSC and State PSCs.

Chronology to know cold: Statutory Civil Service (1879) → Aitchison (1886) → Islington (1912) → Montford (1918) → Lee (1923) → PSC (1926) → Federal PSC (1935/37).

Why it mattered: the ICS became the "steel frame" of British rule. Its racial bar and the age limits became an early grievance of moderate nationalists.

2. Army and police

The army conquered India and the police held it: the army was Indian sepoys under British officers, and the police was a Cornwallis creation that took law and order away from the zamindars.

Army

- Three **Presidency armies** (Bengal, Madras, Bombay), each under its own Commander-in-Chief. They were merged into a single **Indian Army only in 1895**.
- The bulk were Indian **sepoys** (from *sipahi*), but every officer post above *subedar* was British. Indians could not rise to commissioned rank.
- Reasons Indians served: regular pay, which was rare in a time of unemployment, and a tradition of soldiering.
- Discontent built up through low pay, loss of *batta* (foreign-service allowance), and orders that clashed with caste and religion: the **Vellore Mutiny (1806)** and **Barrackpore (1824)**, ending in 1857.

- **After 1857 — Peel Commission (appointed 1858, reported 1859):** more Europeans in the army (about 1 European to 2 Indians in the Bengal army, 2 to 5 in Madras and Bombay); artillery kept in British hands; regiments mixed by caste and region ("divide and counterpoise"); recruitment shifted towards the so-called "martial races" of Punjab, Nepal and the North-West.

Police

- **Cornwallis, 1793: removed police powers from the zamindars**. Districts were divided into **thanas**, each under a **daroga** (an Indian), supervised by the district judge or magistrate. Village watchmen (chaukidars) came under the daroga.
- A **Superintendent of Police** was later created for a division; **Bentinck abolished it** and handed police to the **Collector-Magistrate** (and later to Commissioners).
- **Thagi suppression:** under Bentinck, **Colonel William Sleeman** broke the networks of *thugs* (gangs who strangled travellers on highways) in the 1830s. The **Thagi and Dacoity Department** followed (1835, later extended to dacoity in 1839).
- **Police Commission 1860** (after 1857): one civil police force per province, the military police wound down.
- **Indian Police Act, 1861 (Act V):** an **Inspector-General** in each province, a **District Superintendent of Police** in each district, ranks down to constable; the district magistrate kept general control. This Act still governs many states' police.
- **Police Commission 1902–03 (Sir Andrew Fraser, under Curzon):** found the police inefficient and corrupt. It recommended **better pay and training**, direct recruitment of officers (Indians as Deputy Superintendents), **provincial CIDs** and a **Central Criminal Intelligence Department** at the centre. The CIDs began in 1905.

The police were built to watch the people, not serve them. Even by 1902 the Fraser Commission called the force corrupt and oppressive. Nationalists saw the police as a tool to crush political activity.

3. Judiciary and the codification of law

Warren Hastings laid the foundation (district courts, 1772), Cornwallis separated justice from revenue collection (1793), Bentinck made courts cheaper and more Indian, and Macaulay's Law Commission produced the codes that High Courts applied from 1862.

Warren Hastings — Judicial Plan of 1772

- **District Diwani Adalat** (civil cases) in each district, under the **Collector**. Hindus judged by Hindu law, Muslims by Muslim law; pandits and maulvis advised.
- **District Fauzdari Adalat** (criminal cases) under an **Indian officer** helped by qazis and muftis, with the Collector supervising. Criminal law stayed Muslim law.
- Appeals: **Sadar Diwani Adalat** (civil) at Calcutta under the Governor and Council; **Sadar Nizamat Adalat** (criminal) under an Indian judge (the Naib Nazim), later moved to Murshidabad.
- Not part of his plan: a High Court, or one law for everyone, or separating revenue from justice (all later).
- He had Hindu law compiled in the **Code of Gentoo Laws (1776, translated by N. B. Halhed)**.

Regulating Act 1773 — Supreme Court at Calcutta

- Opened in **1774**: **Sir Elijah Impey** as Chief Justice and three other judges. Original and appellate jurisdiction over British subjects in Calcutta and over Company servants. Its powers clashed with the Governor-General's Council, so the **Act of Settlement (1781)** cut its jurisdiction (revenue matters and acts done in official capacity were excluded).
- **Nandakumar (Nuncomar)**, who had accused Hastings of bribery, was tried by this court and **hanged in 1775 for forgery**. Critics called it a "judicial murder"; Impey was later impeached but acquitted.

Cornwallis — Cornwallis Code (1793)

- **1787:** Collectors made magistrates and civil judges as well (a step back toward combining powers).
- **1790–92:** District Fauzdari Adalats abolished; **circuit courts** under European judges at Calcutta, Dacca, Murshidabad and Patna; Sadar Nizamat Adalat moved to Calcutta under the Governor-General and Council. Muslim criminal law was modified.
- **1793, the Code: revenue and judicial work separated**. The Collector kept only revenue and **lost all judicial power**. A **District Judge** headed the Zila (District) Court.
- Ladder of civil courts: Munsiff and Registrar's courts → District Court → four **Provincial Courts of Appeal** → Sadar Diwani Adalat → King-in-Council (for large sums).
- **Rule of law:** government officials became answerable to civil courts for their official acts. Europeans were also subject to these courts in civil cases.
- Weakness: courts were expensive, slow and in a foreign language, so ordinary peasants rarely got justice.

Bentinck (1828–35)

- Abolished the four Provincial Courts of Appeal and circuit courts; their work went to **Commissioners of Revenue and Circuit**.
- A separate **Sadar Diwani and Sadar Nizamat Adalat at Allahabad** (1831) for the upper provinces.
- Litigants could use **Persian or the local language**; in the Supreme Court, **English** replaced Persian.
- More Indians as judges: **Munsiffs, Sadar Amins and Principal Sadar Amins**, and deputy magistrates.

Codification

- **Charter Act 1833** set up the **First Law Commission (1834) under Macaulay**.
- It drafted the **Indian Penal Code** (draft 1837, enacted **1860**, in force 1862). **Code of Civil Procedure 1859; Code of Criminal Procedure 1861**.

- Hindu and Muslim personal law kept for family matters; the codes gave one criminal law for all, regardless of caste or religion.

Indian High Courts Act, 1861

- **Merged the Supreme Courts and the Sadar Adalats** in each Presidency into one **High Court** at Calcutta, Bombay and Madras (opened **1862**). Allahabad followed in 1866.
- **Federal Court:** set up under the Government of India Act 1935 at Delhi in **1937**; became today's Supreme Court in 1950.

Positives and limits of British justice

- **Positive:** rule of law, equality before law in principle, codified laws, a hierarchy of courts.
- **Limits:** racial discrimination (Europeans could be tried only by European judges until the **Ilbert Bill (1883)** controversy), costly and slow litigation, and courts that favoured the rich and the moneylender.

4. Land revenue systems

Land revenue was the Company's biggest income, and it tried three answers to one question — whom to collect from: the **zamindar** (Permanent Settlement, 1793), the **ryot** or peasant (Ryotwari, from 1820), or the **village as a whole** (Mahalwari, 1822/1833). All three set the demand so high that peasants sank into debt.

Before 1793 — experiments under Hastings

- **1772: five-year (quinquennial) settlement** — the right to collect was auctioned to the highest bidder (revenue farming). Bidders squeezed peasants and often defaulted.
- **1777: back to annual settlements**, also auctioned.
- **1790: Ten-year (decennial) settlement** under Cornwallis, declared **permanent in 1793**. John Shore helped design it.

Feature	Permanent Settlement	Ryotwari	Mahalwari
Year	1793	Tried 1792 (Baramahal); Madras from 1820	1822 (Regulation VII); revised by Regulation IX of 1833
Associated with	Cornwallis (with John Shore)	Alexander Read and Thomas Munro; Elphinstone in Bombay	Holt Mackenzie; R. M. Bird and James Thomason (1833 revision)
Where	Bengal, Bihar, Orissa, Benares division, northern Madras districts	Madras and Bombay Presidencies, Assam, Coorg	North-Western Provinces (UP), Punjab, parts of Central India
Share of British India's land (approx.)	about 19%	about 51%	about 30%
Who paid the state	Zamindar, made owner of the land	Ryot (cultivator), treated as owner	Village headman / lambardar for the whole mahal (village)
Revenue	Fixed for ever: about 10/11 of the rent to the state, 1/11 to the zamindar	Assessed on each plot, often 45–55% of produce; revised every 20–30 years	Assessed village by village, revised periodically (about two-thirds of rental under Bird's settlement)
Key weakness	Peasants became tenants-at-will; zamindars rack-rented	State became one giant zamindar; very high, rigid demand	Over-assessment; headmen took advantage

Permanent Settlement — points that are asked

- Zamindars became **hereditary owners**; land could be sold, mortgaged and transferred.

- **Sunset Law:** if the revenue was not paid by sunset on the fixed date, the estate was sold. Many old zamindari families lost their lands to city merchants. (UPSC 2024 Q57 tested this; UPSC later dropped the question, but the fact is right.)
- **Why the Company liked it:** a fixed, assured income, lower collection costs, and a loyal landlord class. It also hoped zamindars would invest in land. They did not.
- **The flaw for the state:** revenue was fixed for ever, so the Company **could not share in later rises** in output or prices.
- **Subinfeudation:** zamindars leased out their rights to intermediaries (patnidars), who leased further down, creating layers of middlemen between zamindar and cultivator, each taking a cut. The **Patni Regulation (1819)** made this legal.
- **Peasants:** their customary rights were ignored; they became tenants-at-will. **Bengal Rent Act (Act X) of 1859:** a ryot who had cultivated the same land **continuously for 12 years** got **occupancy rights**. Followed by the **Bengal Tenancy Act, 1885**.

Ryotwari — points that are asked

- First tried by **Alexander Read in Baramahal (1792)**, developed by **Thomas Munro**; extended to Madras when Munro became Governor (1820). In Bombay: **Elphinstone** and later Wingate and Goldsmid. (UPSC 2017: Read and Munro, not Cornwallis.)
- The ryot paid directly to the state, with **no intermediary**, and was recognised as owner as long as he paid.
- But there was **no remission for bad harvests**, the demand was high and revised upward, and the state itself acted as the landlord. Moneylenders grew rich.

Mahalwari — points that are asked

- The distinctive feature: revenue settled **with the village community (mahal) as a whole**, with joint responsibility, collected through the headman; individual holdings were also recorded.
- **Holt Mackenzie** proposed it (1819) and **Regulation VII of 1822** began it. It worked badly, so **Regulation IX of 1833 (Bentinck)**

simplified it — **R. M. Bird** (the "father of land settlement in North India") and **James Thomason** carried it out, with field maps and registers.

Chronology question pattern: five-year settlement (1772) → Permanent Settlement (1793) → Regulation IX, Mahalwari (1833).

Overall impact: commercialisation of agriculture, land as a saleable commodity, rise of moneylenders and absentee landlords, frequent land transfers, peasant indebtedness, and peasant revolts.

5. Development of education

Company education went through three phases: **Oriental colleges** to train Indian law officers (1781–1813), a **fight over what to teach** settled in favour of English by Macaulay and Bentinck (1813–1835), and a **full system from school to university** laid down by Wood's Despatch (1854). It had the most questions in today's set (7 directly).

Phase 1 — Oriental learning (to train officials and win over elites)

Year	Institution	Founded by
1781	Calcutta Madrasa (Persian, Arabic, Muslim law)	Warren Hastings
1784	Asiatic Society of Bengal	Sir William Jones
1791	Sanskrit College, Benares (Hindu law and philosophy)	Jonathan Duncan, Resident at Benares
1800	Fort William College, Calcutta (to train British civilians)	Lord Richard Wellesley

UPSC 2018 tested these pairs: the Sanskrit College was Jonathan Duncan, not William Jones; Fort William was Richard Wellesley, not Arthur.

Phase 2 — Who pays, and what to teach (1813–1835)

- Missionaries (Charles Grant, William Wilberforce) and Indian reformers pushed for modern education.

- **Charter Act 1813:** the first state money for education — **not less than ₹1 lakh a year** for reviving literature, encouraging learned Indians, and introducing science. It also let missionaries into India.
- **General Committee of Public Instruction (1823)** to spend the grant. It split into two camps:
- **Orientalists** (H. T. Prinsep, **H. H. Wilson**): Western science through Indian classical languages (Sanskrit, Arabic, Persian); support for traditional learning.
- **Anglicists** (**Macaulay**, Trevelyan): Western learning through **English** only.
- Indians who backed English: **Raja Ram Mohan Roy** (Hindu College, Calcutta, 1817, with David Hare and others).
- **Macaulay's Minute (2 February 1835):** famously dismissive of Oriental learning; wanted "a class of persons Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste". **Bentinck's Resolution (7 March 1835)** made English the medium and directed the funds to Western education.
- **Downward filtration theory:** educate a small upper class in English; knowledge would "filter down" to the masses on its own. It also kept costs low. It failed and was given up with Wood's Despatch.
- **Lord Auckland (1839)** restored some funds to Oriental colleges.
- UPSC 2018: the 1813 Act, the 1823 Committee and the Orientalist–Anglicist debate **all three** led to English education.

Vernacular and technical education

- **William Adam's reports (1835–38):** surveyed **vernacular (indigenous) education in Bengal and Bihar**; found a large network of village schools and noted their defects.
- **James Thomason** (Lt-Governor, NWP, 1843–53): vernacular village schools (halkabandi) and the **Roorkee engineering college (1847)**.
- **Medical College, Calcutta (1835)** under Bentinck.

Wood's Despatch (1854) — the "Magna Carta of English education in India" (Sir Charles Wood, President of the Board of Control; Dalhousie's time)

- The state took **responsibility for mass education**; downward filtration dropped.
- A ladder: vernacular primary schools in villages → Anglo-vernacular high schools → affiliated colleges → universities.
- **English for higher education, vernaculars at school level** (so "English at all levels" is wrong — UPSC 2018).
- **Department of Public Instruction** in each province.
- **Universities** at Calcutta, Bombay and Madras on the London University model — set up in **1857**.
- **Grants-in-aid** to private schools; **teacher training**; **female education**; vocational and technical education.

After the Company (chronology needed for matching)

Year	Body	Viceroy	Key point
1882	Hunter Commission (W. W. Hunter)	Ripon	Reviewed Wood's Despatch; primary education to local boards in vernacular; two streams in secondary school (literary and vocational); female education
1902	Raleigh Commission	Curzon	Reviewed universities
1904	Indian Universities Act	Curzon	More government control over universities
1913	Resolution on Education Policy	Hardinge II	Removal of illiteracy as policy goal
1917–19	Sadler (Calcutta University) Commission	Chelmsford	12-year school course; intermediate colleges; Boards of Secondary Education
1929	Hartog Committee	Irwin	Consolidate primary education rather than expand it; high wastage

Year	Body	Viceroy	Key point
1937	Wardha Scheme (Zakir Husain Committee)	Linlithgow	Gandhi's basic education through a craft
1944	Sargent Plan	Wavell	Universal free education for ages 6–14 within 40 years

Limits: mass education was neglected, women's and technical education were thin, and the English-educated were a small urban elite. Yet that elite read Western ideas of liberty and nationalism and later led the national movement.

6. Press regulations and early newspapers

Press policy swung between control and freedom: **Wellesley censored (1799), John Adam licensed (1823), Metcalfe liberated (1835), Canning re-licensed (1857), Lytton gagged the Indian-language press (1878), and Ripon freed it (1882)**. Remember the hook: *Censor – License – Liberate – License – Gag – Free*.

Year	Regulation	Under	What it did
1799	Censorship of the Press Act	Wellesley	Wartime fear of French propaganda; every paper to print names of printer, editor and owner; all matter pre-censored by the government. Relaxed in 1818 (Hastings/Moira).
1823	Licensing Regulations	John Adam (acting GG)	Printing without a licence was a penal offence; aimed mainly at Indian-language papers. Ram Mohan Roy stopped *Mirat-ul-Akhbar* in protest.
1835	Press Act (Metcalfe Act)	Charles Metcalfe (acting GG)	Repealed the 1823 rules; printer/publisher only had to declare the premises. Metcalfe = **"Liberator of the Indian Press"**.
1857	Licensing Act	Canning	Emergency of 1857; licensing back for one year; power to stop any publication.

Year	Regulation	Under	What it did
1867	Press and Registration of Books Act	Lawrence	Regulated rather than restricted: printer, publisher, place on every book and paper; copy to government.
1878	Vernacular Press Act	Lytton	Applied **only to Indian-language papers**; magistrate could demand a bond and seize the press; **no appeal to a court**.
1882	Vernacular Press Act repealed	**Ripon**	Indian-language papers freed again
1908	Newspapers (Incitement to Offences) Act	Minto II	Seize presses printing matter that incited violence
1910	Indian Press Act	Minto II	Revived the worst of the 1878 Act; security deposits
1931	Indian Press (Emergency Powers) Act	Willingdon	Against Civil Disobedience propaganda

Vernacular Press Act, 1878 — why it is asked

- Called the **"Gagging Act"**. It came after Indian papers criticised the government over the 1876–78 famine and the lavish Delhi Durbar of 1877.
- **Discriminatory:** English-language papers were **exempt**. This is the Statement-II that explains Statement-I in today's set.
- The *Amrita Bazar Patrika* turned into an English paper overnight to escape it.
- Indian Association and others protested; **Ripon repealed it in 1882**.

Early newspapers

Year	Paper	Founder / language
1780	*Bengal Gazette* (Calcutta General Advertiser) — first newspaper in India	James Augustus **Hicky** (English); seized in 1782 for criticising Hastings
1818	*Samachar Darpan*	**Serampore missionaries** (J. C. Marshman), Bengali
1821	*Sambad Kaumudi*	**Ram Mohan Roy**, Bengali
1822	*Mirat-ul-Akhbar*	**Ram Mohan Roy**, Persian
1822	*Bombay Samachar*	Fardunji Marzban, Gujarati (still published)

So of *Sambad Kaumudi, Mirat-ul-Akhbar, Bombay Samachar, Samachar Darpan*, only the **first two** are Ram Mohan Roy's. He also published the English *Brahmanical Magazine*.

Section 124A (sedition) was added to the IPC in **1870**; it was later used against Tilak and Gandhi.

7. Economic impact, famines and the drain of wealth

Company rule turned India from an exporter of finished cloth into an exporter of raw cotton and an importer of British goods; land revenue and trade profits left the country as a "drain", and famines grew more deadly.

Three phases of colonialism (Bipan Chandra, after R. P. Dutt)

1. **Mercantile phase (1757–1813):** monopoly trade plus plunder. The Company used Bengal's revenue to buy Indian goods for export, so no bullion had to come from Britain ("investment").
2. **Industrial capital / free trade phase (1813–1858):** after the **Charter Act 1813**, India was opened to British manufacturers. India became a **market for British factory goods and a supplier of raw materials** (cotton, indigo, jute, opium). British goods entered almost duty-free; Indian goods faced high duties in Britain ("one-way free trade").

3. **Finance imperialism (from about 1860):** British capital poured into railways, banks, plantations, mines and loans to the Government of India, with guaranteed returns.

Charter Acts and trade (an easy trap)

- **1813:** ended the Company's monopoly of **Indian trade**, **except tea and trade with China**. (UPSC 2019 asked this; it also asserted the Crown's sovereignty over the Company's territories.)
- **1833:** ended the remaining monopoly (tea and China) and **ended the Company's commercial functions** altogether; it became purely an administrative body.
- So a statement "1813 ended the tea and China monopoly" is **wrong**.

Deindustrialisation

- Indian handicrafts, especially **cotton textiles**, declined sharply in the first half of the 19th century because cheap **machine-made British cloth** flooded the market, Indian goods were taxed out of Britain, and Indian courts that had bought luxury crafts disappeared.
- Artisans moved to agriculture, raising pressure on land. India went from net cloth exporter to net importer.
- No modern industry grew in their place in this period (the first cotton mill came in Bombay in 1853–54, jute mill at Rishra in 1855). So "growth of modern Indian industry" is **not** a consequence of Company policy before 1857.

Agriculture

- Commercialisation: cash crops (indigo, cotton, jute, opium, tea) grown for export, often under pressure. Indigo collapsed in the early 20th century because **synthetic dyes** made it unprofitable (UPSC 2020).
- Stagnation, falling productivity, rise of moneylenders, land changing hands.

Famines and famine policy

- **Great Bengal Famine, 1770:** a few years after the Company got the **Diwani (1765)**; about one-third of Bengal's people died; the Company kept collecting revenue — a key charge against it.
- Under the Company there was no famine policy; relief was left to charity. A policy began only after the Crown took over.

Famine	Commission (report year)	Chairman	Viceroy	Key point
Orissa, 1865–66	Campbell (1866)	Sir George Campbell	John Lawrence	Blamed government machinery; first official inquiry
1876–78 (Madras, Bombay, UP, Punjab)	**Strachey, the first Famine Commission (1880)**	Sir Richard Strachey	Lytton	Principles of relief; relief is the state's duty; remit revenue; famine fund; led to the **Famine Code (1883)**
1896–97	Lyall (1898)	Sir James Lyall	Elgin II	Endorsed 1880 principles; more irrigation
1899–1900	MacDonnell (1901)	Sir Antony MacDonnell	Curzon	Early advances for seed and cattle, famine commissioner, more non-official help
Bengal, 1943	Woodhead (1944)	Sir John Woodhead	Wavell	Blamed administration and hoarding

Order to remember: **C-S-L-M** — Campbell, Strachey, Lyall, MacDonnell. Note: Campbell came after the **Orissa 1866** famine, not 1770.

Drain of wealth

- **Meaning:** the part of India's national product that went to Britain with nothing coming back in return.

- **Components: Home Charges** (paid in England: interest on public debt raised there, India Office costs, pensions and leave pay of officials, army costs), salaries and savings sent home by British officials, and profits on foreign capital and trade.
- **Dadabhai Naoroji first put forward the theory in 1867** in his paper *England's Debt to India* (not R. C. Dutt). Congress adopted it in 1896.

Book	Author
Poverty and Un-British Rule in India **(1901)**	**Dadabhai Naoroji**
Economic History of India **(1901–03)**	**R. C. Dutt**
Prosperous British India **(1901)**	**William Digby**
Essays on Indian Economics **(1898)**	**M. G. Ranade**

Transport and communication — mostly Dalhousie (1848–56)

- **Railway Minute (1853):** a trunk network linking ports with the interior; private British companies built lines with a **guaranteed 5% return** paid from Indian revenue.
- **First passenger train: Bombay to Thane, 16 April 1853** (34 km). Calcutta–Raniganj followed in 1854, Madras in 1856.
- **Telegraph:** first line Calcutta–Agra (1853–54), under O'Shaughnessy; it helped crush the 1857 revolt.
- **Post Office Act 1854: uniform postage** (half an anna) regardless of distance; postage stamps introduced.
- **Public Works Department** set up as a separate department (1854); Ganga Canal opened (1854).
- **Purpose:** these served British trade and military needs first — moving raw materials to ports and goods and troops inland — but they also unified India and helped nationalist communication later.

8. Who did what: administrative measures by Governor-General

Most "which measure belongs to whom" questions come down to five names; this table pulls the administration side of yesterday's notes and today's together.

Governor-General	Civil service / police	Courts and law	Land, education, press, economy
Warren Hastings (1772–85)	Ended Dual Government; Company took direct charge	Judicial Plan 1772; Supreme Court 1774; Code of Gentoo Laws; Nandakumar 1775	Five-year revenue farming 1772; Calcutta Madrasa 1781; Asiatic Society 1784 (Jones)
Cornwallis (1786–93)	Father of the civil service; police taken from zamindars, thanas under darogas	Cornwallis Code 1793; separation of revenue and justice; circuit courts	Permanent Settlement 1793
Wellesley (1798–1805)	Fort William College 1800	—	Censorship of the Press Act 1799
Bentinck (1828–35)	Indians as deputy collectors and in uncovenanted posts (not the covenanted ICS); Thagi suppressed (Sleeman); Superintendent of Police abolished	Provincial and circuit courts abolished; Allahabad Sadar Adalats; vernaculars allowed in courts; Law Commission (Macaulay)	Sati abolished 1829; Macaulay's Minute and English education 1835; Calcutta Medical College 1835; Regulation IX (Mahalwari) 1833; flogging in the army ended
Metcalfe (acting, 1835–36)	—	—	Press Act 1835 — "Liberator of the Indian Press"

Governor-General	Civil service / police	Courts and law	Land, education, press, economy
Dalhousie (1848–56)	Open competition (Charter Act 1853)	—	Railway Minute 1853 and first train; telegraph; Post Office Act 1854; PWD; Wood's Despatch 1854; Widow Remarriage Act prepared (passed 1856 under Canning)
Canning (1856–62)	Police Commission 1860; Police Act 1861	IPC 1860; High Courts Act 1861	Universities 1857; Licensing Act 1857; Act X of 1859

Bentinck trap from today's set: he did **not** open the covenanted civil service to Indians by examination. That came with the Charter Act of 1853 (open competition) and Satyendranath Tagore in 1863. Bentinck opened the subordinate (uncovenanted) posts.

9. Before the test: traps, past UPSC questions and memory hooks

Read this page last, just before you start the test.

Fifteen traps

1. Cornwallis **took** police powers **from** the zamindars; he did not hand them back.
2. The Cornwallis Code **stripped the Collector of judicial powers**; it did not make him a judge.
3. Warren Hastings' 1772 plan had **no** High Court and no separation of revenue and justice.
4. Supreme Court, Calcutta: Regulating Act **1773**, opened **1774**, **Elijah Impey**; Nandakumar hanged **1775** for **forgery**.
5. Charter Act **1813**: ₹1 lakh for education; monopoly ended **except** tea and China. **1833** ended tea and China and all trade.

6. Charter Act **1833** said no Indian could be barred; **1853** brought the open exam; first exam **1855** in London.
7. First Indian in ICS: **Satyendranath Tagore, 1863**.
8. Order of service commissions: **Statutory Civil Service 1879 → Aitchison 1886 → Islington 1912 → Lee 1923–24**.
9. Sanskrit College Benares = **Jonathan Duncan**; Asiatic Society = **William Jones**; Fort William = **Richard** Wellesley.
10. Wood's Despatch: English for **higher** education, vernaculars at school level; grants-in-aid; universities 1857.
11. Adam's reports (1835–38) = **vernacular education in Bengal and Bihar**.
12. Liberator of the press = **Metcalfe (1835)**; Licensing 1823 = **John Adam**; VPA 1878 = **Lytton**, repealed **1882 by Ripon**; English papers were **exempt** from the VPA.
13. Ram Mohan Roy's papers: **Sambad Kaumudi and Mirat-ul-Akhbar**; *Samachar Darpan* was the Serampore missionaries'.
14. Ryotwari = **Read and Munro** (not Cornwallis); Mahalwari = **Holt Mackenzie 1822, Regulation IX 1833 (Bird, Thomason)**; Mahalwari = **NWP and Punjab**; Act X of 1859 = **12 years** for occupancy rights.
15. Drain theory first = **Naoroji, 1867**; first Famine Commission = **Strachey, 1880**; Campbell = Orissa famine, 1866.

Real UPSC Prelims questions on today's chapters (they are in the app's UPSC PYQ papers)

Year	Question	Answer
2017	Who introduced Ryotwari: Cornwallis, Alexander Read, Thomas Munro?	Read and Munro only
2018	Wood's Despatch: grants-in-aid; universities; English at all levels	First two only
2018	What led to English education: Charter Act 1813, Committee of Public Instruction 1823, Orientalist–Anglicist debate	All three

Year	Question	Answer
2018	Pairs: Benares Sanskrit College–William Jones; Calcutta Madrasa–Warren Hastings; Fort William–Arthur Wellesley	Only the Madrasa pair
2019	Charter Act 1813: ended monopoly except tea and China; asserted Crown sovereignty; Parliament controlled revenues	First two only
2020	Why did indigo decline by 1900?	Synthetic dyes made it unprofitable
2020	Why did Wellesley found Fort William College?	To train British civilians for administration
2024	Cornwallis revenue: Ryotwari exempted bad harvests; zamindar lost estate if he missed the date	Dropped by UPSC; first statement wrong, second right

Memory hooks

- **Pillars:** *"My Civil Army Polices Judges' Land, Educates, Presses the Economy"* — Money (revenue), Civil service, Army, Police, Judiciary, Land, Education, Press, Economy.
- **Press:** *Censor (1799) – License (1823) – Liberate (1835) – License (1857) – Gag (1878) – Free (1882)*: Wellesley, Adam, Metcalfe, Canning, Lytton, Ripon.
- **Famine commissions: C-S-L-M** (Campbell 1866, Strachey 1880, Lyall 1898, MacDonnell 1901) — "Can Strachey Lift Many?"
- **Land: Z-R-M** — Zamindar (Cornwallis, east), Ryot (Read and Munro, south and west), Mahal (Mackenzie, north).
- **Education ladder: 1781 Madrasa → 1791 Sanskrit College → 1813 one lakh → 1823 Committee → 1835 Macaulay → 1854 Wood → 1857 universities → 1882 Hunter**.
- **Drain books:** *Poverty* = Naoroji; *Economic History* = Dutt; *Prosperous* = Digby (sarcastic title); *Essays* = Ranade.

How to make it stick: after the test, add every wrong answer's fact to this page's margin as a comment, and revise this page on days 1, 3, 7 and 21 — the same rhythm as the app's mistake book.

Sources: Spectrum, *A Brief History of Modern India*; M. Laxmikanth, *Indian Polity*; Bipan Chandra; Vision IAS, Vajiram and Ravi and GKToday notes; UPSC Prelims papers. Written in my own words for study. Dates for minor items vary slightly between books.